06 DEEPFAKES WILL GET WORSE

Just like ransomware, deepfakes are projected to become more pervasive and sophisticated in 2025, posing significant challenges across various sectors, according to various cybersecurity reports. The increasing accessibility of AI tools enables malicious actors to create highly convincing fake videos and audio, facilitating the easy spread of misinformation, fraud, and identity theft. For example, in the US Presidential Election 2024, deepfake technology was used to spread misinformation by impersonating political figures, leading to incidents like the AI-generated robocalls in New Hampshire that discouraged voting by mimicking President Joe Biden's voice. Not just limited to impersonating popular figures, the financial sector is also increasingly at risk, with deepfakes being employed to bypass identity verification processes. A report from Entrust Cybersecurity Institute revealed that in 2024,

a deepfake attack occurred every five minutes, highlighting the frequency and effectiveness of such tactics. Moreover, the proliferation of deepfake pornography has raised serious ethical and legal concerns. In South Korea, a surge in AI-generated explicit images led to legislative action criminalising the possession and distribution of non-consensual deepfake content.

07 AUTOMOTIVE THREATS GEARING UP

By 2025, there are expected to be over 400 million connected cars in operation, up from 237 million in 2021, according to a Statista report. As vehicles become increasingly connected and autonomous, they are more susceptible to cyberattacks targeting their complex electronic systems. A report by Research and Markets highlights that effective automotive cybersecurity now requires cross-industry collaboration to address threats both within the vehicle and its external networks, including infrastructure.

The integration of AI and machine learning into vehicular systems introduces new vulnerabilities. Cybercriminals will no doubt exploit these

technologies to manipulate vehicle behaviour or access sensitive data. Trend Micro's subsidiary, VicOne, emphasises that as vehicles progress toward software-defined models, the attack surface expands, necessitating robust cybersecurity measures.

The rise of electric vehicles (EVs) and their associated infrastructure, such as charging stations, presents additional challenges. In India and around the world, there's an increased need for securing clean energy infrastructure from potential cyberattacks, recognising the critical need to protect EVs and their charging networks. Furthermore, concerns about foreign-manufactured vehicles have emerged.

08 SOCIAL MEDIA THREATS LOOM LARGE

Social media, once a platform for connection, is now a breeding ground for cybercrime. The integration of GenAI with social media has amplified these threats, making it easier for criminals to launch highly targeted and sophisticated attacks, according to Check Point Software Technologies